



Putting Rayla on the map

A setup guide for Google Business Profile

Everything to have ready, every step in order, and the mistakes that get a new profile suspended before it has earned its first review.

Prepared for

Ednar Nankya

Founder & Creative Lead

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The questions you asked

Settle all of this before you open the laptop. Every answer below is a field Google will ask you for, in the order you will meet them.

Google account	hello@rayladigitalagency.com Used as a Google account. You do not need a Gmail address.
The listing	Claim the one that already exists RAYLA DIGITAL is already on Maps, unclaimed. Do not create a second.
Business name	Rayla Digital Agency The listing says RAYLA DIGITAL. Correct it during the claim if Google gives you the field.
Business type	Service business Not online retail, not a local store.
Primary category	Marketing agency Google has already put this on the listing. Keep it.
More categories	Four to six, not nine Internet marketing service, Video production service, Graphic designer, Marketing consultant.
Service areas	Kampala, Wakiso, Entebbe, Mukono, Jinja Optional field, worth filling. Five is the right number; twenty is not.
Phone	Settle which number is real first The website and the Maps listing currently disagree. See question six.
Website	https://www.rayladigitalagency.com With the https:// and with the www, exactly as written here.
Address	Enter the real one, then hide it No address yet? You can carry on and verify by phone, email or video.

Can hello@rayladigitalagency.com be the account, or do we need to make one?

Yes, it can — and it is the right choice. You do not need a Gmail address.

A *Google account* and a *Gmail inbox* are two different things, and people conflate them constantly. Google will happily create an account on an email address you already own somewhere else, which is exactly what hello@rayladigitalagency.com is: a Zoho mailbox that Rayla controls.

How to do it

1. Go to **accounts.google.com/signup**.
2. Fill in the name, then on the username step choose **“Use my current email address instead”**. It is a small link under the username box and it is easy to miss.
3. Type *hello@rayladigitalagency.com*.
4. Google emails a six-digit code to that address. Open the Zoho inbox, read it, type it in.

From then on, the sign-in username is the full address. No Gmail inbox is created, nothing about Zoho changes, and the enquiries from the website keep arriving exactly where they arrive now.

The one thing to check first

Somebody has to be able to **open that mailbox** to read the verification code. The website's forms deliver into it, so it certainly receives mail — but receiving is not the same as being able to log in. Before setup day, sign in at **mail.zoho.com** with that address and confirm you get an inbox. If it turns out hello@ only forwards to somewhere else, the code will land in that other inbox instead, which is fine as long as you know where to look.

If you cannot get into it

Then make a Gmail — something plain like *rayla.digital.agency@gmail.com* — and treat it as company property rather than anybody's personal account. It is second best, not a disaster. Write it on the record page at the back of this guide either way.

Whichever account you use

Switch on **2-Step Verification** and set a recovery phone and recovery email *before* you start the profile. Losing this account means losing the profile, and Google's recovery runs through the account, not through the business listing. If Google tells you the address already has an account on it, someone has signed up with it before — use "Forgot password" to get back in rather than creating a second one.

Watch out. Whoever is signed in when the profile is claimed becomes its Primary Owner, and that person can remove everyone else. This is the whole reason you are doing the setup rather than anyone helping with the marketing.

Rayla is already on Maps, but there is no "claim this business". What now?

Nothing is wrong. That panel is Google's view of an unclaimed listing, and you claim it from the Business Profile side rather than from Maps.

Look at what the panel is offering you: *Suggest an edit, Add missing information, Add hours, Add website, Add a photo*. Those are the things Google shows to a member of the public looking at a listing **nobody owns**. Google built RAYLA DIGITAL itself from information it gathered — the name, the phone number and the category *Marketing agency* are already sitting there — and it is waiting for someone to take it. The claim link genuinely is missing from that desktop panel much of the time; it is not a sign that the listing is taken.

Three ways in, best first

1. **business.google.com/add** — signed in on the account that will own the profile. Start typing *Rayla Digital*. The existing listing appears in the dropdown below the box. **Click the existing listing**, not the "create a business with this name" option underneath it. That starts the claim, with the details already filled in.
2. **The Google Maps app on your phone.** Open the listing, scroll all the way past the photos and details to the bottom, and *Claim this business / Own this business?* is down there. The phone app shows it far more reliably than the desktop site.
3. **Sign in first, then search.** If you are browsing signed out, or signed in as a personal account, Google sometimes hides the link entirely.

If Google says someone has already claimed it

Choose **Request access**. Google emails the current owner and gives them three to seven days to respond. If they do not respond, you can take it. While you wait, do nothing else — above all, do not create a second listing.

Getting the name to say Rayla Digital Agency

The listing reads **RAYLA DIGITAL**. The real name is **Rayla Digital Agency**, and that is what the profile should say. Google's rule is that the name must match the one the business uses in the real world — on its signage, its invoices and its registration — so this is a correction, not an attempt to game anything. Google accepts corrections like this routinely. The capitals should go too: Google only allows a name in full capitals where the brand is genuinely styled that way, and Rayla's is not.

What matters is *when* you change it.

- **If the claim flow gives you the name to edit before you verify, change it there.** That is much the cleanest moment. Verification is then done against the corrected name, and the signage, the URSB certificate and the website all agree with it. A profile that says RAYLA DIGITAL while every document you show says Rayla Digital Agency is a mismatch the reviewer has to resolve, and the way reviewers resolve mismatches is by rejecting.
- **If the name comes through locked, verify first.** Then leave it a week or two and change it on its own, as the only edit you make that week. Name changes on a freshly verified profile go back into review, and a review that arrives on top of three other changes is the one that ends in a suspension.

Either way, have the URSB certificate to hand. If Google queries the change, the name on that document is the whole answer.

The map pin

It currently sits well north of Kampala rather than where the business actually is. Leave it until you are verified and settled, then drag it to the right place as a separate change — one edit, then a week, then the next.

Watch out. If claiming feels awkward, the temptation is to create a fresh profile instead. Don't. Duplicate listings are the single most common reason a new profile is suspended, and untangling two of them takes weeks of appeals.

Online retail, local store or service business — which is Rayla?

Service business.

The three options describe how a customer gets what they are buying, not what industry you are in.

- **Online retail** means you sell products through a website and ship them out. Rayla sells work, not stock.
- **Local store** means customers travel to a premises and buy there — a shop, a salon, a restaurant. Nobody walks into an agency to buy something off a shelf.
- **Service business** means you deliver at the client's place, or remotely. That is Rayla exactly: shoots on location, strategy in meetings and calls, everything else handed over digitally.

What the choice actually changes

Picking service business tells Google to stop treating your street address as a shopfront. It lets you **hide the address**, it opens up the service-areas field, and the profile still appears in local Kampala results. Choosing local store instead would publish the address and put opening hours front and centre.

The one exception

If Rayla has an office with signage where clients are genuinely welcome to turn up, you can have both: a visitable address *and* service areas. Only take that route if somebody is reliably there during the hours you publish. An office that is locked when a client arrives earns a one-star review that outlives the inconvenience.

Our category is digital marketing, right?

Close. The category to use is Marketing agency — which is what Google has already assigned to the listing, so keeping it is one less change to make.

The **primary category** is the most powerful field on the entire profile. It decides which searches Rayla is eligible to appear in at all, and there is only one of it. *Marketing agency* is the broadest honest fit for the mix of work Rayla does, it is already on the listing, and the two obvious alternatives are narrower: *Advertising agency* leans towards paid media buying, and *Internet marketing service* leaves out the production and brand work.

Then the additional categories

Google allows up to nine more. You can only choose from Google's own list, and that list changes, so type the words and take whatever the dropdown offers. Against Rayla's six services:

- Digital Marketing → **Internet marketing service**
- Digital Content Production → **Video production service**
- Graphic Design → **Graphic designer**
- Brand Consulting → try **Marketing consultant**, or **Business management consultant**
- Social Media Management → try **Social media agency**; if Google does not offer it, *Internet marketing service* already covers the ground
- Content Strategy → usually has no category of its own. It belongs in Services, not Categories

Add four to six, not nine

Every category is a promise. It brings enquiries for that exact thing, and an enquiry you have to turn down sends somebody straight back to the search results — which Google notices and reads as a bad match. Add what you would happily be hired for tomorrow, and add more later once the performance report tells you what people are actually searching.

Not the same thing. Categories are Google's fixed list. **Services** is a separate section further down where you write your own names in your own words — Social Media Management, Content Strategy, Brand Storytelling, Campaign Management, Event Management — with a line of description each. That is where Rayla's language belongs.

Where do you serve your customers — what goes here, and how many?

Fill it in, and list five. Kampala, Wakiso, Entebbe, Mukono, Jinja.

The field is optional, but for a service business it is worth filling because it is the only place a stranger learns whether Rayla will travel to them. Type a town or a district and pick from Google's suggestions; it will not accept free text.

Why five and not twenty

Google allows up to twenty, and the instinct is to use all of them. It does not work, because **service areas are not a ranking lever**. Google ranks a service business mainly on where its pin sits relative to whoever is searching, so listing twenty districts will not put Rayla into twenty sets of results. What it will do is make the profile read as unfocused — a small Kampala agency claiming to cover the whole country persuades nobody, and Google's own guidance is to stay within roughly a two-hour drive of where the business actually operates.

The five, and why

- **Kampala** — the base, and where most clients are.
- **Wakiso District** — covers Nansana, Kira and most of the ring around the city.
- **Entebbe** — the airport corridor, and a genuinely separate search.
- **Mukono** — the eastern edge of the commuter belt.
- **Jinja** — far enough to be worth saying, close enough to be true.

Add Nansana or Kira as well if you would really drive there for a half-day shoot. Leave them off if you would not.

What not to put here

Not Nairobi, not Kigali, not "East Africa", even though remote work for clients there is real and the website says so. Service areas are about where you will physically travel, and Google checks whether the claim is plausible. The website's FAQ is the right place for the remote answer, and it already handles it.

This is one of the safe fields: you can change the areas at any time afterwards without triggering a fresh review. So five now, adjusted later, is exactly the right way to treat it.

For contact details we put our number and the website link?

Yes — one phone number and the website, written exactly the way they are written everywhere else Rayla appears. But the number needs settling first.

Two different phone numbers are in circulation

The website publishes **+256 764 065 441**. The Google listing in the screenshot shows **0746 065441**, which is **+256 746 065 441**. The middle digits are swapped, so one of the two is wrong.

Work out which one is the real number before setup day, then make the profile, the website, the WhatsApp business account and every social bio say the identical thing. This is not housekeeping: Google compares the phone number across everywhere it finds Rayla, and a business that appears under two numbers is a business it trusts less and ranks lower. There is no error message for this — it just quietly costs you.

The phone field

Enter it in international format: **+256 7XX XXX XXX**. Use a number a person actually answers during the hours you are about to publish, and have that phone in your hand during setup — if Google offers verification by call or text, the code arrives on it.

The website field

Type **https://www.rayladigitalagency.com** — with the *https://* and with the *www*, because that is the canonical form the site itself declares. Not the bare domain, not a shortened link, not a Linktree. If the two forms disagree, Google has to guess which page is the real one.

Worth adding while you are there

Google offers an appointment or booking link field. Point it at the discovery-call form on the website. It turns the profile from a phone number into something a client can act on at eleven at night, which is when a good many of these decisions get made.

And the mailing address to verify — can she verify later if there is no address?

Yes. If Rayla has a real address, enter it and hide it. If there is none yet, you can carry on and verify by phone, email or video instead.

The first thing to understand is that this address field is **for Google, not for customers**. Google asks a service business for it to confirm the business is where it says it is, and to have somewhere to post a verification postcard if it comes to that. Immediately afterwards Google asks whether you want to show the address to customers. **Answer no**. It then stays hidden, and the public sees only the service areas.

If you have an address today

Use it — the office, or wherever the work genuinely happens from. Enter it in full, then **drag the map pin onto the actual doorway**, because Google's automatic pin regularly lands on the wrong side of the road and that pin is what a client's navigation follows. Then hide it. This is the best case: the

address is private, and postcard verification stays available as a fallback if the video route goes wrong.

If you have no address yet

Google lets a service business continue without one. Verification then goes by phone, email or video rather than by post — which is no bad thing, since postcards to Kampala addresses are slow and frequently never arrive. Google will ask again later, and you can add the address whenever there is one.

What “verify later” really means

You can finish the whole profile and leave verification for another day, and as a schedule that is fine. But understand what you are choosing: **nothing on an unverified profile is public**. The photos, the hours, the description and the services all sit in a draft that only you can see, and the listing on Maps stays the unclaimed one anybody can edit. Treat “later” as a few days, not a few months.

Watch out. Never use a coworking desk, a virtual office, a mailbox service or a PO box, and never borrow a friend's address. Google looks for these and removes the profiles that use them, usually without warning. And do not type a placeholder meaning to correct it afterwards — changing the address after verification triggers a fresh review, and sometimes a suspension.

Why this is worth an hour of your time

Read this part once. The rest of the guide you can work through with the laptop open.

When somebody in Kampala searches *marketing agency near me*, *video production Kampala*, or simply *Rayla*, Google shows a map with three businesses on it before it shows a single website. A Google Business Profile is how Rayla gets into that list. It is free, it takes about an hour, and nothing else in local marketing returns as much for as little.

It also decides what people see when they search for Rayla by name. Right now that space is empty, or worse, filled in by Google from scraped data that nobody at Rayla controls. Once the profile is claimed and verified, you own it: the photos, the hours, the description, the phone number people tap.

What the profile actually gives you

- **A place in the map results** for searches Rayla currently cannot appear in at all.
- **A panel beside search results** with photos, hours, services, and a call button.
- **Reviews.** Google displays them itself, which is why they carry more weight with a stranger than testimonials on your own site.
- **Numbers.** How many people found you, what they searched to get there, how many called, how many asked for directions. That last one is quietly the most useful marketing data Rayla will get for free.
- **Control.** Anyone can suggest an edit to an unclaimed listing. Verified owners approve or reject those edits.

One thing to settle before you touch anything

Whoever is signed in to Google when the profile is created becomes its **Primary Owner**. That person can remove everybody else; nobody can remove them.

This is why you are the one doing the setup. Create it on an account that belongs to the business, and add anyone who helps with the marketing as a **Manager** afterwards. Managers can post, reply to reviews, and edit the listing. They cannot take it with them.

Before you begin

Gather all of this first. Stopping halfway to hunt for a document is how details end up wrong, and wrong details are hard to change later.

The account

- ☐ **A Google account on `hello@rayladigitalagency.com`**, created the way question one describes. It does not need to be a Gmail address, and Zoho carries on unchanged.
- ☐ **The Zoho password for that mailbox**, tested at *mail.zoho.com* before setup day, so the verification code can be read.
- ☐ **2-Step Verification switched on**, with a recovery phone and recovery email set, before you start. Losing access to this account means losing the profile.
- ☐ **The password stored somewhere a second person at Rayla can reach it** if your phone is lost or stolen.

The business details

- ☐ **The name exactly as it appears on your signage, invoices and registration:** Rayla Digital Agency. Nothing after it.
- ☐ **The address you will give Google**, if there is one — it stays hidden, so this is for Google's eyes. Note the exact spot on the map too; if the street address is loose, press and hold on the doorway in Google Maps and copy the **Plus Code**. Question seven covers what to do if there is no address yet.
- ☐ **A decision about the phone number.** The website says +256 764 065 441, the Maps listing says 0746 065441. Settle which is real, and have that phone with you during setup.
- ☐ **The website address:** <https://www.rayladigitalagency.com>
- ☐ **Opening hours**, honestly. Including Saturday, and whether the office closes over lunch.
- ☐ **A description** of about 750 characters, drafted before you sit down.
- ☐ **A list of services**, with one line of description for each.

The pictures

- ☐ **A square logo**, at least 720 × 720 pixels.
- ☐ **A landscape cover photo**, at least 1080 pixels wide, that shows the team or the work rather than a graphic.
- ☐ **Eight to twelve real photographs:** the team working, a shoot in progress, edits on a screen, the office from outside. No stock imagery, no watermarks, nothing that is mostly text.

For verification

- ☐ **Your URSB certificate of incorporation or registration**, and a trading licence if you have one.
- ☐ **Something tying the business to the address:** a tenancy agreement, or a utility bill in the business name.
- ☐ **Visible signage or branding at the location.** If there is none, put something up before you record.
- ☐ **A charged phone, and forty-five uninterrupted minutes** at the place the business works from, during daylight. If it comes to video verification, that is where it is filmed.

The setup, in order

Do these in sequence. Steps 4 and 6 are the two that decide whether the profile is approved.

0

2 minutes

Confirm the listing is still unclaimed

Search *Rayla Digital* on Google Maps. If the panel still offers *Suggest an edit* and *Add missing information*, nobody owns it and it is yours to take. If it has changed and Google now says the business is verified, someone has claimed it since — go straight to *Request access*, as question two describes, and wait.

Watch out. Duplicate listings are the most common reason a new profile is suspended, and untangling two listings takes weeks of appeals. However awkward the claim gets, do not start a fresh one.

1

3 minutes

Sign in as the business

Sign out of every personal Google account first, or open a separate browser window for this. Whichever account is active becomes the Primary Owner, and switching that afterwards is a formal transfer, not a settings change.

2

6 minutes

Claim it, and say what kind of business it is

Go to **business.google.com/add**. Start typing *Rayla Digital* and **click the existing listing** in the dropdown, not the option underneath to create a new business with that name. That starts the claim with the details already filled in. If the listing does not appear, question two has the other two routes.

Google then asks what kind of business this is: online retail, local store, or service business. Choose **service business** — it is the answer that lets you hide the address and set service areas.

The name comes through from the claim as **RAYLA DIGITAL**. If Google lets you edit it here, correct it to **Rayla Digital Agency** now, before verifying — that way the paperwork you show later agrees with it. If the field is locked, leave it, verify, and change it a week or two afterwards as an edit on its own. Question two explains why the timing matters.

Watch out. When you do come to correct the name, put nothing after it. "Rayla Digital Agency Kampala | Social Media & Branding" is a suspension, not a ranking. The name field is for the name.

3

10 minutes

Choose the categories

Primary category: **Marketing agency**. It is already on the listing and it is the right one, so this step is mostly a matter of leaving it alone.

Then four to six additional categories, taken from question four: *Internet marketing service*, *Video production service*, *Graphic designer*, *Marketing consultant*, and *Social media agency* if Google offers it. Type the words and take what the dropdown gives you — you can only choose from Google's own list, and it changes.

Watch out. Do not fill all nine slots because they are there. Every category is a promise to deliver, and enquiries you turn down send people back to the search results, which counts against you.

4

10 minutes

Address, then service areas

The address. Enter the real one if there is one, drag the map pin onto the actual doorway, and then tell Google *not* to show it to customers. Google's automatic pin regularly lands on the wrong side of the road, and that pin is what a client's navigation follows. If there is no address yet, carry on without one — question seven covers what changes.

The service areas. List five: Kampala, Wakiso District, Entebbe, Mukono, Jinja. Not twenty, and nothing outside Uganda. Question five explains why more is worse here.

Watch out. Never list a coworking desk, a virtual office, a mailbox service, or a PO box. Google removes these when it finds them, and it looks for them.

5

5 minutes

Phone and website

The number you settled on, in international format, answered by a person during the hours you are about to publish. Then the website: **https://www.rayladigitalagency.com**, with the https:// and the www.

Then check that the name, address and phone number here are written *identically* to the website, the Facebook page, the Instagram bio, and any directory Rayla appears in. Same spelling, same formatting, same number. Google compares these to decide whether it believes you exist, and inconsistency is a slow, invisible drag on ranking.

6

20 minutes

Verification

Google will offer one or more of: a recorded video, a live video call, a phone call or text, an email, or a postcard. **Choose video if it is offered.** Postcards to Kampala addresses are slow and frequently never arrive.

For the recorded video you film **one continuous take with no cuts and no editing**, showing, in this order:

1. The outside: the street, the building, and your signage.
2. The walk in from the street to where you work, so the two connect.
3. Inside: desks, cameras, lights, computers. The tools the business runs on.
4. Proof you are the one running it: unlocking a door or a drawer, opening the URSB paperwork, signing in to the business email on screen.

Narrate as you go. Keep colleagues' faces out of it unless they have agreed. If it is rejected you can usually record again, so read the reason Google gives before you do.

Watch out. Verification takes anywhere from a few minutes to five working days. While you wait, do not create another profile and do not change the business name or address. Both restart the process.

7

25 minutes

Fill in everything else while you wait

A complete profile ranks better and gets more calls than a sparse one, and this part can be done before verification comes through. Add the opening hours, and set **special hours** for the public holidays you close on. Add the services with their short descriptions, the year Rayla opened, and a booking link pointing at the consultation form on the website.

Then the description. Lead with what Rayla does and where it does it, because that opening sentence is all most people read. Keep phone numbers and web addresses out of it; Google strips them and it reads as spam.

8

15 minutes

Photos

Upload the logo and the cover first, then the rest. Give the files descriptive names before uploading. Profiles that get new photos regularly are shown noticeably more often, so plan on adding two or three a month rather than emptying the whole archive today.

9

10 minutes

Messaging and questions

Turn on chat only if somebody will reply the same day, because Google publishes your average response time next to it.

Then go to the questions section and post your own, with answers: *Do you work with businesses outside Kampala? What does a monthly social media retainer include?* Anyone on the internet can answer a question on your profile. Fill that space before somebody else does.

10

5 minutes

Add the team

Open the profile's settings, then *People and access*, then add. Invite whoever handles the marketing as a **Manager**. They can post, reply to reviews, upload photos and edit the details. Only you, as Primary Owner, can add or remove people or transfer the business.

Watch out. Never give Primary Owner to a contractor, a freelancer or an agency, however much you trust them. Manager access does everything the work needs.

11

ongoing

Ask for reviews, carefully

The profile gives you a short review link. Send it to clients you have finished work with, one at a time, in a message that mentions what you did for them. Five genuine reviews in the first month is a good target.

Reply to every review, warm or difficult, within a few days. A calm reply to a bad review persuades more people than the review discourages.

Watch out. Do not offer discounts, airtime or anything else in exchange for a review. Do not post reviews from staff accounts or from a second phone. Google spots clusters of reviews that arrive together from related devices, and it removes them — sometimes taking the profile with them.

Where this goes wrong

Every one of these is common, and every one of them costs more to undo than to avoid.

Creating the profile on a personal Gmail

The profile belongs to a person, not the business. When that person changes phone, leaves, or forgets the password, Rayla loses the listing and has to fight Google to get it back.

Instead: create it on a business account with recovery details set, before step 1.

Putting keywords in the business name

The fastest route to suspension there is. It is also the most reported violation, because competitors report it.

Instead: the real name only. Keywords belong in categories, services and the description.

Leaving the map pin where Google dropped it

Clients follow the pin, not the address text. A pin on the wrong plot produces phone calls from people standing outside somebody else's gate.

Instead: drag it to the doorway yourself, then test it by asking for directions from somewhere across town.

Using a coworking space, virtual office or PO box as the address

Google treats these as fake locations and removes the profile, usually without warning.

Instead: use a real premises, or hide the address and run it as a service-area business.

Publishing a home address you did not want public

Once it is indexed it spreads to other directories, and pulling it back is slow.

Instead: decide at step 4, before you type it, and use service areas if there is any doubt.

Picking a vague primary category

The profile quietly never appears for the searches that matter, and there is no error message to tell you.

Instead: choose the most specific category that is genuinely true, then review it after a month against the search terms in the performance report.

Rewriting the name, address or category days after verification

Large edits immediately after approval trigger a fresh review, and sometimes a suspension.

Instead: get the details right before submitting. If something must change, wait a week or two and change one thing at a time.

Different phone numbers or spellings across the website and social accounts

Google cannot confirm the business is one business, so it trusts the profile less and ranks it lower.

Instead: write the name, address and phone number once, then copy that exact text everywhere.

Setting it up, then never touching it again

Profiles with no recent posts, photos or review replies slide down the results while active competitors climb past.

Instead: fifteen minutes a week, on the same day each week. See the next page.

Buying reviews, or asking staff and family to post them

They are detected and deleted, and repeat attempts can cost the profile permanently. It is the one mistake here that is not recoverable.

Instead: ask real clients directly, personally, and soon after the work lands well.

If the profile is suspended anyway

Do not create a replacement, and do not delete anything. Read the notice for the reason, fix that specific thing, and submit the reinstatement appeal form Google links from the notice. Appeals usually resolve within a couple of weeks. A second profile turns a fixable suspension into a permanent one.

The first thirty days

Setup is the easy half. This is the half that produces enquiries.

Week one

Verify. Fill in every field the profile offers, including the ones that feel minor. Upload ten photos. Add managers. Post your own questions and answer them.

Week two

Send the review link to five past clients, individually, each with a sentence about the work you did together. Reply to every review that arrives.

Week three

Publish the first post: a project, a new service, a hire, a behind-the-scenes shot from a shoot. Posts expire after about a week, which is the whole point of them being a habit.

Week four

Open the performance report. Look at calls, direction requests, website clicks, and especially the search terms people used to find Rayla. Those terms tell you which categories and services to add next.

After that

One post a week. Two or three photos a month. A reply to every review and question. Updated hours before every public holiday. Fifteen minutes, same day each week.

Three numbers worth watching

Direction requests tell you people intend to turn up in person. **Calls from the profile** tell you the listing is doing sales work the website is not. **The search terms report** tells you, in your clients' own words, what Rayla is being hired for — which is worth more than any of it.

Compare them month to month, not day to day.

Worksheet

Print this page and fill it in before you open the laptop. Every field here maps to a field in the setup.

Google account for the profile

hello@rayladigitalagency.com. 2-Step Verification on, recovery phone and email set

Business name, exactly as it will be published

No location, no services, no punctuation you would not put on a signboard

Primary category

Marketing agency, unless you have a reason

Additional categories

Four to six, all genuinely true

Address (hidden), and the five service areas

Add the Plus Code from Google Maps if the street address is imprecise

Phone number

The one you settled on. +256 7XX XXX XXX

Website

<https://www.rayladigitalagency.com>

Opening hours

Monday to Saturday, plus any holidays you close

First sentence of the description

This is the part people read. What Rayla does, and where.

Services to list

One line of description each

Managers to invite

Google email addresses, Manager access only

First five clients to ask for a review

Recent, and happy

Keep a record

Fill this in once the profile is live, and keep it where a second person at Rayla can find it. Not the password — that belongs in a password manager, not on paper.

Google account the profile lives on

Date verified

Recovery email on that account

Recovery phone on that account

Primary Owner

Ednar Nankya — this should not change without a deliberate transfer

Managers, and the date each was added

Three things that will come up later

The office moves. Change the address on the profile in the same week, and update the website, Facebook and Instagram the same day. A profile whose address disagrees with the website loses ranking quietly.

Someone leaves the team. Remove their access from *People and access* the day they go. Managers keep working access until they are removed.

You cannot get into the account. Recovery goes through the Google account, not through the profile. If the recovery email and phone from step 1 are not set and current, there is no route back — which is the reason they are step 1.

Rayla Digital Agency hello@rayladigitalagency.com +256 764 065 441 rayladigitalagency.com